Buckman E.S.

Changes beginning in 2027-28

WHAT'S CHANGING?

- Buckman School would close as a school building.
- The Arts special-focus choice program would close.
- Neighborhood boundary split: Buckman neighborhood students living south of E. Burnside St. would move to Abernethy E.S. Buckman neighborhood students living north of E. Burnside St. would move to Sunnyside K-5.
- Special Education students in the SES classrooms would move to Sunnyside K-5. Special Education students receiving Learning Center support would continue to receive support at either Abernethy E.S. or Sunnyside K-5.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

- The Buckman building needs major repairs. The school requires urgent structural fixes and heavy maintenance to make it safe and modern.
- Enrollment is dropping. Buckman is expected to drop to just 239 students over the next few years, making it difficult to fund full programs and staffing.
- Nearby schools are in better shape. Both Abernethy and Sunnyside have better buildings and are in good locations to welcome Buckman families.

WHAT ELSE WAS CONSIDERED?

- Building condition over size: Even though Buckman is a larger building than Abernethy, Buckman's building repair needs are severe.
- Title I Funding Support: District teams considered Buckman's Title I status carefully to ensure students moving to receiving schools continue to get strong learning and family support services.

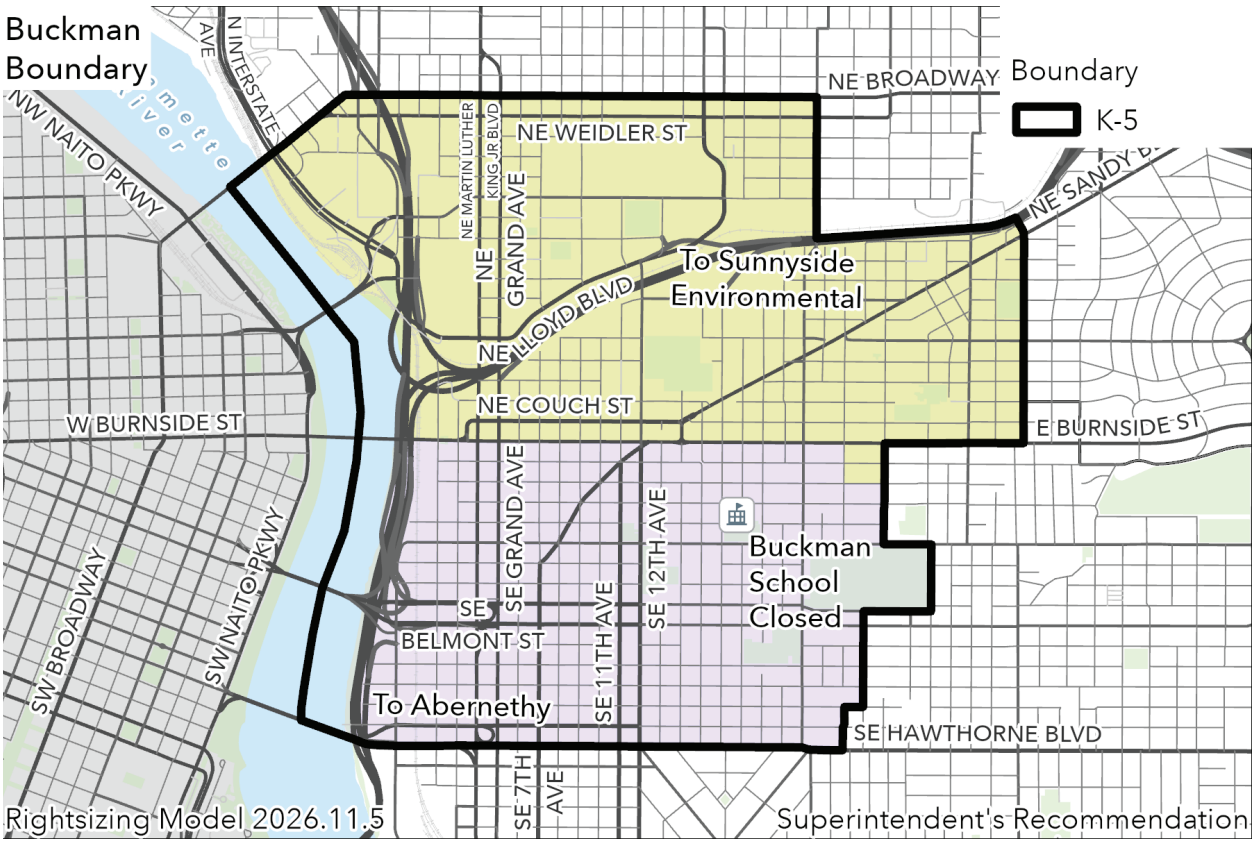
WHAT WOULD STUDENTS GAIN?

- Better, safer classrooms: Moving to Abernethy and Sunnyside means learning in updated buildings with better resources and learning spaces.
- More support and activities: Combining school communities gives students access to more classmates, full-time staff, and steady classroom support.

- Support over time: Bringing students together creates larger, stronger schools that keep their funding and programs reliable over time.

WHERE WOULD THE SCHOOL BOUNDARY BE?

Abernethy E.S. and Sunnyside Environmental boundaries



Combined school includes students from: Buckman, Abernethy and Sunnyside Environmental. Students would join all in 2027-28.

PROJECTED ENROLLMENT

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Status Quo/No Change	244	245	248	246	239
Recommendation	School would close				

ENROLLMENT AND TRANSFER

- Neighborhood students: K-4th grade students and incoming kindergartners residing in the Buckman E.S. attendance area north of E Burnside St. will enroll at Sunnyside E.S.
  K-4th grade students and incoming kindergartners residing in the Buckman E.S. attendance area south of E Burnside St. will enroll at Abernethy E.S.

- PPS transfer students: K-4th grade students attending Buckman E.S. but not residing in the Buckman E.S. attendance area will enroll at Sunnyside E.S. or may transfer to their neighborhood school by home address.

School transition supports: Teams from Central Office have developed a framework for implementing Rightsizing. This includes a menu of transition supports for all impacted school communities. This work is informed by lessons learned by districts across the country that have had successful school consolidations. The implementation framework includes guidance on merging academic programs and school-based teams, (such as Instructional Leadership, Climate, PTAs and others) tools, resources, and timelines. The framework includes timelines for merging school communities and onboarding staff, families and students to their new campuses. It also includes staffing timelines and plans for packing and moving furniture and instructional resources. This comprehensive framework will be shared with the community in December. If the Board of Education votes to proceed with Rightsizing for fall 2027, Central Office teams will begin working with school communities in January to implement transition supports appropriate to each community.